

Dustin Swonder

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, University of California, Berkeley, expected 2027
Principal advisor: Danny Yagan
Other references: Matteo Benetton, Patrick Kline, Emmanuel Saez

PRIMARY FIELDS: Public Finance, Household Finance
SECONDARY FIELDS: Labor Economics, Real Estate, Applied Microeconomics

A.B. Applied Mathematics *magna cum laude*, Harvard University, 2019

RESEARCH

“Homeownership and Liquidity: Evidence from a California Lottery,” (Job market paper, with Ian Sapollnik) In preparation.
“Crisis Relief through the Tax Code: Effects of Corporate Loss Refunds on Firms and Workers,” (with Ian Sapollnik) In preparation.
“A Sufficient Statistics Approach to Optimal Corporate Taxes,” (with Damián Vergara) Revisions requested, *Journal of Political Economy*.
“Tax Policy and Business Entry” (with Ian Sapollnik) *Journal of Public Economics* 2025, 252: 105537.
“A Simple Model of Corporate Tax Incidence,” (with Damián Vergara) *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 2024, 114: 352-357.

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

2026 Urban Economics Assn. North American Meeting Best Student Paper Award Honorable Mention
2026 Institute for Research on Labor and Employment Dissertation Fellowship
2026 Stone Center for Wealth and Income Inequality Fellowship
2025 Burch Center for Tax Policy and Public Finance Fellowship
2024 George Break Prize in Public Finance
2023 National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship
2018 Harvard Institute of Politics Summer Service Fellowship
2017 Certificate of Distinction in Teaching, Derek Bok Center for Teaching and Learning at Harvard

GRANTS

2025 Opportunity Lab Place-Based Policy Initiative Graduate Research Award
2025 Fisher Center for Real Estate and Urban Economics Research Grant
2025 Institute for Research on Labor and Employment Graduate Research Award
2025 Economists for Equity at Berkeley Small Grant

PRESENTATIONS, INCLUDING SCHEDULED

- 2027 American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association Annual Conference
- 2026 UC Berkeley, California Policy Lab, Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics – Public Economics, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, Urban Economics Association North American Meeting
- 2025 UC Berkeley, California Housing Finance Agency, Turner Center for Housing Innovation, National Tax Association Annual Conference*, NBER Economic Analysis of Business Taxation Fall Meeting*
- 2024 UC Berkeley, AEA Annual Meeting*
- 2023 UC Berkeley, International Political Economy Society Conference*
- Pre-Ph.D. U.S. Treasury Department Office of Economic Policy, Carroll Round International Economics Conference

* conference presentation by co-author

EMPLOYMENT

Teaching

- 2024–25 ECON 230A Graduate Public Economics, grader – UC Berkeley
- 2022 ECON 140 Econometrics, departmental tutor – UC Berkeley
- 2021 ECON 100B Macroeconomics, departmental tutor – UC Berkeley
- 2019 MATH 112 Introductory Real Analysis, course assistant – Harvard University
- 2017–18 MATH 18 Multivariable Calculus for the Social Sciences, course assistant – Harvard University

Research

- 2025 Graduate research assistant at the Turner Center for Housing Innovation at UC Berkeley
- 2022–24 Graduate research assistant for Danny Yagan, UC Berkeley Economics Department
- 2019–21 Research assistant for Owen Zidar, Princeton Program in Public Finance
- 2018 Research assistant intern at U.S. Treasury Department Office of Economic Policy
- 2017 Research assistant intern at The Brookings Institution Metropolitan Policy Program

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee service: *Econometrica*, *Journal of Public Economics*

Committee service: UC Berkeley Economics PhD Program Student Admissions Review Committee (2023–present); UC Berkeley Graduate Economics Association (co-chair, 2022–23)

Organizing service: UC Berkeley Public Finance Third-Year Advising Group (2023–24); UC Berkeley Business Taxation Reading Group (2023)

Mentoring & diversity service: UC Berkeley Undergraduate Research Assistant Program (2023–25); Berkeley Economists for Equity Faculty Recruitment Initiative (2023–24)

Workshops attended: UC Berkeley Stone Center Summer Institute (2023); Becker Friedman Institute Price Theory Summer Camp (2022)

OTHER INFORMATION

US Census Bureau Special Sworn Status (2024–)

Born 1996 in Richmond, Indiana.

Updated October 2026